

LAB 2 · DETAILED STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Claims Approval & Routing Flow

When a new claim hits the SharePoint list, branch by amount, gather the right approval in Teams, notify the claimant, log the audit trail. End-to-end in 90 minutes.

DURATION 90 minutes	DIFFICULTY Intermediate	OUTPUT Working approval flow
PREREQUISITE Lab 1 completed	TOOLS Power Automate · Teams · SharePoint	CODING None — expressions optional

WHAT YOU WILL BUILD

A cloud flow that triggers every time a new takaful claim is created. It inspects the amount, routes low-value claims to a fast-track reviewer and high-value claims to a senior reviewer, gathers the approval inside Microsoft Teams, then updates the claim's status, emails the claimant, posts to the operations channel, and writes an immutable audit log entry. Lab 1 built the front door; Lab 2 is the workflow behind it.

What's in this guide

Each part builds on the previous. Verification checkpoints at the end of every part tell you what you should see before continuing.

Part	Topic	Time
0	Before you begin — prerequisites and access checks	5 min
1	Add the audit-log SharePoint list	10 min
2	Create the flow and set the trigger	10 min
3	Add the routing condition (amount-based)	5 min
4	Configure the Teams approvals in both branches	20 min
5	Handle the approval response (update + email)	20 min
6	Notify the team and write the audit log	10 min
7	Test the flow end-to-end (all four paths)	10 min
8	Troubleshooting reference	as needed
9	Stretch goals (sentiment, SLAs, multi-approver)	post-workshop
10	Self-check before you call it done	5 min

HOW TO READ THE ACTION TABLES

Each Power Automate action in this guide is shown as a two-column table — Field on the left, Value on the right. Values shown in monospace come from dynamic content; click 'Add dynamic content' in Power Automate and pick the matching field.

Square-bracket references like [ClaimantName] mean 'pick that field from the trigger output via the dynamic-content panel'. Don't type the brackets.

Part 0 — Before you begin

Five minutes of setup. The flow will not function if any prerequisite is missing.

Confirm Lab 1 is complete

Lab 2 depends on the SharePoint list and the Power App from Lab 1. If you didn't complete Lab 1, ask the facilitator for the starter list before continuing.

1. You have a SharePoint list named **Takaful Claims Intake** with at least the columns ClaimantName, CertificateNo, ClaimType, IncidentDate, ClaimAmount, Description and Status.
2. You can submit a claim using the Claims Intake app from Lab 1, and it appears in the SharePoint list.
3. You know the SharePoint site URL.

Pick your test approver

Approvals in Power Automate must go to a named, licensed Microsoft 365 user. Distribution lists, shared mailboxes, and Microsoft 365 Groups silently fail. Pair up with someone in the room and use each other's emails — that way you'll both see real approvals land in Teams during testing.

1. Decide your **fast-track approver** (handles claims under RM 5,000). Note their email.
2. Decide your **senior approver** (handles RM 5,000 and above). Note their email.
3. In a workshop setting, both can be the same person. In production they must be different.

Pick or create the notification channel

The flow will post a summary message to a Teams channel after each decision. You need somewhere for that to land.

1. Open Microsoft Teams.
2. Pick an existing channel where the team is comfortable receiving claim notifications, OR create a new channel called **#takaful-claims** inside any team you own.
3. Note the Team name and Channel name — you'll select them from a dropdown later.

Tabs to keep open

- Power Automate maker portal — make.powerautomate.com
- SharePoint site (for inspecting list changes during testing)
- Microsoft Teams (to watch approvals and channel posts arrive)
- The Claims Intake app from Lab 1 (to submit test claims)
- This guide

COMMON STUMBLE

If make.powerautomate.com shows you a 'no licence' error, you don't have a Power Automate licence. Stop here and raise it. The labs can't proceed without it.

If your tenant restricts the Approvals connector, you'll need administrator approval to use it. Raise this BEFORE building — the symptom otherwise is a flow that runs but never delivers an approval card to Teams.

Verify Part 0

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ Lab 1's Takaful Claims Intake list exists and has records.
- ✓ make.powerautomate.com loads without a licence error.
- ✓ You have a named fast-track approver and senior approver (emails ready).
- ✓ You have a Teams channel chosen for notifications.

Part 1 — Add the audit-log SharePoint list

Every approval decision needs an immutable record. We add a second list now because it's easier to wire the flow when both lists exist from the start.

Step 1.1 — Create the list

1. Open the same SharePoint site you used for Lab 1.
2. Click **+ New** → **List** → **Blank list**.
3. Name: **Claims Audit Log**
4. Description (optional): **Immutable record of all approval decisions**
5. Toggle **Show in site navigation** on. Click **Create**.

Step 1.2 — Configure the columns

Rename the default Title column, then add six more. Use exactly the names shown — they will be referenced by the flow.

Column name	Type	Settings
AuditID (rename Title)	Single line of text	Required: No. Used as a free-text reference if needed.
ClaimID	Number	Required: Yes. The ID of the claim from the intake list.
ClaimantName	Single line of text	Required: Yes. Copied from the claim at decision time.
Approver	Person or Group	Required: Yes. Single user. Shows who made the decision.
Outcome	Choice	Choices: Approved, Rejected, Auto-Routed. Required: Yes.
Comments	Multiple lines	Plain text, 4 lines. Approver's free-text notes.
DecisionTimestamp	Date and time	Include time: Yes. Captures the exact moment of decision.

WHY A SEPARATE LIST

The intake list captures what claimants submitted. The audit log captures what reviewers decided. Separating them means a reviewer never accidentally edits a claimant's submission, and the audit trail can be retained on its own schedule — important for Shariah committees and PDPA compliance.

Verify Part 1

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ The list is named exactly 'Claims Audit Log'.
- ✓ All seven columns exist with the exact spelling above.
- ✓ ClaimID is a Number column (not text — this matters for filtering later).
- ✓ Outcome has three choices: Approved, Rejected, Auto-Routed.

Part 2 — Create the flow and set the trigger

We're going to build an automated cloud flow that runs every time a new claim lands in the intake list.

Step 2.1 — Start a new automated flow

1. Go to make.powerautomate.com.
2. Confirm the environment selector (top right) matches the environment you used in Lab 1.
3. In the left navigation, click **+ Create**.
4. Choose **Automated cloud flow**.
5. Flow name: **Claims Approval & Routing**
6. In the trigger search box, type `created sharepoint` and pick **When an item is created** (the SharePoint one, not the SharePoint Online one labeled deprecated).
7. Click **Create**.

Step 2.2 — Configure the trigger

The trigger needs to know which list to watch. Click the trigger step in the canvas to expand it.

Field	Value
Site Address	Pick your SharePoint site from the dropdown (the one with the Takaful Claims Intake list).
List Name	TakafulClaims

Step 2.3 — Rename the trigger step

Now — before you do anything else — rename the trigger step.

1. Click the ... (three dots) on the top right of the trigger card.
2. Click **Rename**.
3. New name: `When a new claim is created`

RENAME FIRST, CONFIGURE SECOND — ALWAYS

Renaming a step in Power Automate AFTER you've configured downstream actions silently breaks dynamic-content references in those downstream actions. The downstream fields don't show errors — they just go blank at runtime. Make 'rename first, configure second' a habit for every step you add.

Step 2.4 — Save

1. Click **Save** (bottom right).

2. Wait for the 'Your flow has been saved' message before continuing.

Verify Part 2

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ The flow exists and is saved.
- ✓ The trigger is renamed to 'When a new claim is created'.
- ✓ The trigger points to your SharePoint site and the Takaful Claims Intake list.

Part 3 — Add the routing condition

Branch the flow based on claim amount. High-value claims need senior approval; everything else fast-tracks.

Step 3.1 — Add a Condition action

1. Below the trigger, click **+ New step**.
2. In the action search, type condition and pick **Condition** under Control.

Step 3.2 — Rename the condition step

1. Click ... → **Rename**.
2. New name: Route by amount

Step 3.3 — Configure the condition

The condition has three fields: a left value, an operator, and a right value.

1. Click the **Choose a value** field on the left.
2. In the dynamic content panel that pops out, scroll to find **ClaimAmount** and click it.
3. In the operator dropdown (middle), select **is greater than or equal to**.
4. In the right-hand value field, type the number **5000** (no quotes, no commas).

WHY 5,000 RINGGIT

RM 5,000 is a workshop default. In production, work with your operations and Shariah teams to set the threshold(s) — they may want separate tiers for different claim types (e.g. medical might fast-track up to RM 10,000; motor only up to RM 3,000). Tiered thresholds can be added later by nesting conditions inside each branch.

Step 3.4 — Understand the branches

The Condition action creates two branches:

Branch	Meaning
If yes (right side)	ClaimAmount ≥ 5,000 — high-value claim, route to senior reviewer.
If no (left side)	ClaimAmount < 5,000 — fast-track, route to standard reviewer.

Verify Part 3

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ A Condition action exists below the trigger, named 'Route by amount'.
- ✓ The condition reads: ClaimAmount is greater than or equal to 5000.
- ✓ Two empty branches are visible — 'If yes' and 'If no'.

Part 4 — Configure the Teams approvals

Each branch needs its own approval — same action, different approver and title prefix. We'll build the high-value branch first, then the fast-track branch.

Step 4.1 — Add the senior approval (high-value branch)

1. In the **If yes** branch, click **+ Add an action**.
2. Search for approval and pick **Start and wait for an approval** (under Approvals).
3. Rename the step: click ... → **Rename** → **Senior approval**.
4. Configure the fields as below:

Field	Value
Approval type	Approve/Reject — First to respond
Title	High-value claim: [ClaimantName] – RM [ClaimAmount]
Assigned to	your.senior.approver@yourcompany.com (a named licensed user)
Details	Multi-line; see Step 4.2 for the template
Item link	[Link to item] (from dynamic content of the trigger)
Item link description	Open the claim in SharePoint
Enable notifications	Yes (default)
Enable reassignment	Yes

Step 4.2 — Fill in the Title and Details

For Title, click into the Title field, then click 'Add dynamic content' (the lightning icon) and build the value piece by piece:

1. Type **High-value claim:** as plain text.
2. Add dynamic content → click **ClaimantName** from the trigger output.
3. Type **– RM** as plain text.
4. Add dynamic content → click **ClaimAmount**.

For Details, you want the approver to see everything they need to decide. Use this template:

DETAILS (MARKDOWN IS SUPPORTED)

```
**Claimant:** [ClaimantName]
**Certificate No:** [CertificateNo]
**Claim Type:** [ClaimType Value]
**Incident Date:** [IncidentDate]
**Amount:** RM [ClaimAmount]
```

```
**Description:**
[Description]
```

Please review the supporting documents attached to the claim before responding.

CHOICE COLUMNS EXPOSE TWO VALUES

ClaimType is a Choice column. In Power Automate's dynamic-content panel you'll see two entries: ClaimType Value (the display text — what you want) and ClaimType Id (an internal number). Always pick ClaimType Value. Picking ClaimType Id gives you numbers in the approval card that mean nothing to the reviewer.

Step 4.3 — Add the fast-track approval (low-value branch)

Same action, different setup.

1. In the **If no** branch, click + **Add an action**.
2. Add another **Start and wait for an approval** action.
3. Rename: Fast-track approval.
4. Configure exactly the same way as the senior approval, with these differences:

Field	Value
Title	Fast-track: [ClaimantName] – RM [ClaimAmount]
Assigned to	your.fasttrack.approver@yourcompany.com (different named user)
Details	Use the same Markdown template, but optionally trim the Description

WHY DIFFERENT TITLES

When the approver opens Teams, they often have multiple pending approvals. The prefix ('High-value claim' vs 'Fast-track') lets them spot the urgent ones at a glance, even when many are queued. This is small but compounds when the flow runs hundreds of times a week.

Step 4.4 — Save and pause

Save the flow before adding response handling. If your tenant ever logs you out, you don't want to lose the approvals configured above.

1. Click **Save**.
2. Wait for confirmation.

Verify Part 4

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ Two approval actions exist — one in each branch.
- ✓ Both are renamed (Senior approval, Fast-track approval).
- ✓ Titles use dynamic content for ClaimantName and ClaimAmount.
- ✓ Each Assigned to field has a real licensed user email — not a group or shared mailbox.
- ✓ Details use ClaimType Value (not Id).

Part 5 — Handle the approval response

Each approval returns an Outcome of either 'Approve' or 'Reject'. We need to update the claim's status and email the claimant differently in each case.

BUILD ONCE, COPY TWICE

The response-handling pattern is the same in both branches — only the Status values are identical and the email wording is the same. Build the structure once inside the 'If yes' branch first; once it works, you can copy the actions into the 'If no' branch.

Step 5.1 — Add a nested Condition (inside If yes)

1. In the 'If yes' branch, below the Senior approval step, click **+ Add an action**.
2. Pick **Condition** again.
3. Rename it: Was it approved
4. Configure:

Field	Value
Left value	[Outcome] (from Senior approval dynamic content)
Operator	is equal to
Right value	Approve

IT'S 'APPROVE', NOT 'APPROVED'

The Outcome field returns the verb 'Approve' or 'Reject' — not the past tense 'Approved' or 'Rejected'. If your condition reads 'is equal to Approved' it will never match, and every claim will silently fall into the wrong branch.

Step 5.2 — On approval (inner 'If yes')

Two actions: update the claim's Status, then email the claimant.

Action: Update item

1. Inside the inner 'If yes' branch (the one nested under 'Was it approved'), click **+ Add an action**.
2. Search `update item` → pick **Update item** (SharePoint).
3. Rename: Mark claim as approved
4. Configure:

Field	Value
Site Address	(same as trigger)
List Name	Takaful Claims Intake
Id	[ID] (from trigger dynamic content)
Title	[Title] (preserve the existing value)
Status Value	Approved

UPDATE ITEM IS DESTRUCTIVE

If you leave required fields blank in the Update item action, Power Automate will **OVERWRITE** them with empty values. Always pass the original value back into every required field via dynamic content (Title, ClaimantName, etc.), even if you're not changing them. Easiest pattern: bind every field to its own trigger output, then change only Status.

Action: Send claimant email (approved)

1. Below Update item, + **Add an action**.
2. Search **send an email** → pick **Send an email (V2)** (Office 365 Outlook — NOT 'Outlook.com').
3. Rename: **Email claimant – approved**
4. Configure:

Field	Value
To	[ClaimantEmail] if your list captures it; otherwise the approver's email
Subject	Your takaful claim has been approved – [CertificateNo]
Body	See template in Step 5.3 below
Importance	Normal

Step 5.3 — Email body template (approved)

BODY (HTML OR PLAIN TEXT)

```
Dear [ClaimantName],

Good news – your claim under certificate [CertificateNo]
for RM [ClaimAmount] has been approved.

Our team will be in touch within 3 working days with
next steps and disbursement details.

If you have any questions, please reply to this email or
contact our claims hotline.

Thank you for choosing us for your takaful needs.

– The Claims Team
```

Step 5.4 — On rejection (inner 'If no')

Mirror the approved-path structure. The differences are the Status value (Rejected) and the email wording.

Action: Update item

1. In the inner 'If no' branch (under 'Was it approved'), add an **Update item** action.
2. Rename: `Mark claim as rejected`.
3. Same configuration as Step 5.2 except Status = Rejected.

Action: Send claimant email (rejected)

1. Add another **Send an email (V2)**.
2. Rename: `Email claimant – rejected`.
3. Subject: `Update on your takaful claim – [CertificateNo]`.

4. Body:

BODY — REJECTION

Dear [ClaimantName],

Thank you for submitting your claim under certificate [CertificateNo]. After review, we are unable to approve your claim at this time.

****Reviewer's comments:****

[Comments] (from Senior approval / Fast-track approval)

You have the right to appeal this decision. To do so, please reply to this email within 14 days with any additional supporting documents.

We value you as a participant. Please don't hesitate to contact our claims hotline if you have questions.

– The Claims Team

BE CAREFUL WITH [COMMENTS]

Approvers sometimes write internal notes they don't expect the claimant to see. In a real deployment, either prompt approvers to write claimant-facing comments only, or add an additional 'Public reason' field to the audit log and only use that in the rejection email.

Step 5.5 — Copy the pattern to the 'If no' (fast-track) branch

You've now built the full response pattern under the 'If yes' (senior approval) branch. Repeat the same four steps under the 'If no' (fast-track approval) branch:

1. Add a nested Condition: `Outcome is equal to Approve`.
2. On approval: Update item (Status = Approved) → Email claimant.
3. On rejection: Update item (Status = Rejected) → Email claimant.
4. Crucial: when you add Update item and Send email in this branch, the dynamic content panel will show outputs from **Fast-track approval**, not 'Senior approval'. Use the Fast-track outputs — otherwise Power Automate will complain about scope.

APPROVAL OUTPUTS ARE SCOPED

An action can only see dynamic content from steps that run before it on the same branch. If your inner condition under Fast-track tries to use [Outcome] from Senior approval, Power Automate shows a 'cannot use' validation error. Always pick the dynamic content that matches the approval action you're inside.

Verify Part 5

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ Both branches now have a nested Condition checking Outcome equals 'Approve'.
- ✓ Each branch has Update item actions for both approved and rejected outcomes.
- ✓ Each branch sends a different email for approved vs rejected outcomes.
- ✓ Status values are exactly 'Approved' and 'Rejected' (matching SharePoint choices).
- ✓ No red error indicators on any action.

Part 6 — Notify the team and write the audit log

Two final actions run regardless of outcome — a Teams channel post for visibility, and an audit-log entry for compliance.

WHERE TO PUT THESE ACTIONS

We want both the Teams post AND the audit log entry to run for EVERY outcome — approved or rejected, high-value or fast-track. That means they belong OUTSIDE the inner 'Was it approved' condition, but INSIDE each outer branch (because we don't have a single 'after the condition' spot in classic flows).

Add the two actions to the bottom of each outer branch — once under 'If yes', once under 'If no'. Four actions total.

Step 6.1 — Post message in the Teams channel (high-value branch)

1. In the 'If yes' outer branch, scroll past the inner 'Was it approved' condition.
2. Below the inner condition (still inside the outer 'If yes'), click **+ Add an action**.
3. Search `post message` → pick **Post message in a chat or channel** (Microsoft Teams).
4. Rename: `Post to team channel`.
5. Configure:

Field	Value
Post as	Flow bot
Post in	Channel
Team	(your team from Part 0)
Channel	(your channel from Part 0)
Message	See template below

MESSAGE BODY

```

**Claim decision – [CertificateNo]**
Claimant: [ClaimantName]
Amount: RM [ClaimAmount]
Type: [ClaimType Value]
Branch: High-value (senior reviewer)
Outcome: [Outcome] by [Responder name]
Comments: [Comments]

```

Step 6.2 — Audit log entry (high-value branch)

1. Below the Post message action, **+ Add an action**.
2. Search `create item` → pick **Create item** (SharePoint).
3. Rename: `Log decision to audit`.
4. Configure:

Field	Value
Site Address	(same as trigger)
List Name	Claims Audit Log
AuditID	AUD-[ID] (concatenate prefix with the claim's ID)
ClaimID Value	[ID] (from trigger)
ClaimantName Value	[ClaimantName] (from trigger)
Approver Claims	[Responder email] (from Senior approval)
Outcome Value	[Outcome] = Approve → 'Approved'; else 'Rejected' (see expression below)
Comments	[Comments] (from Senior approval)
DecisionTimestamp	utcNow()

Step 6.3 — Map Outcome verb to Status noun

The approval returns the verb 'Approve' / 'Reject'. The audit log wants the past tense 'Approved' / 'Rejected'. Use an expression to translate.

OUTCOME VALUE (EXPRESSION)

```
if(
    equals(outputs('Senior_approval')?['body/outcome'], 'Approve'),
    'Approved',
    'Rejected'
)
```

To enter this:

1. Click the **Outcome Value** field.
2. Click **Expression** (the second tab in the dynamic-content pop-out).
3. Paste the expression above. Replace `Senior_approval` with the exact step name (underscores instead of spaces). Power Automate's Intellisense will help.
4. Click **OK**.

STEP NAMES IN EXPRESSIONS

When you reference a step in an expression, Power Automate replaces spaces with underscores. 'Senior approval' becomes 'Senior_approval'. If you renamed the step earlier (as you should have!), use the renamed version's underscored form here.

Step 6.4 — Repeat for the fast-track branch

Repeat steps 6.1 — 6.3 in the 'If no' (fast-track) outer branch. The only difference: in the audit-log expression, replace 'Senior_approval' with 'Fast-track_approval' (or whatever exact name you gave that step).

Step 6.5 — Save and check the canvas

1. Save the flow.
2. Look at the canvas — both outer branches should now contain:
 - Approval action (Senior or Fast-track)
 - Nested Condition (Was it approved)
 - Update item + Email — in each nested branch
 - Post to team channel
 - Log decision to audit

Verify Part 6

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ Two Post message actions exist — one per branch.
- ✓ Two Create item actions exist (writing to Claims Audit Log) — one per branch.
- ✓ The audit log Outcome value uses an expression that translates 'Approve' to 'Approved'.
- ✓ DecisionTimestamp uses utcNow().
- ✓ The flow has no validation errors.

Part 7 — Test the flow end-to-end

Four paths must all work: high-value approved, high-value rejected, fast-track approved, fast-track rejected. Skipping any of these is how unhappy claimants and broken audit trails are discovered in production.

Step 7.1 — Turn the flow on

1. From the flow's detail page, click **Turn on** if it isn't already.
2. Confirm it shows 'On' under Status.

Step 7.2 — Test path 1: high-value, approved

1. Open the Claims Intake app (from Lab 1) on your phone or browser.
2. Submit a claim with `ClaimAmount = 8500` (or any value $\geq 5,000$).
3. Wait up to 5 minutes (yes, really — SharePoint triggers can be slow on first fire).
4. Watch Microsoft Teams. An approval card should land in the senior approver's Teams account, titled 'High-value claim: ...'.
5. Click **Approve**. Add a brief comment like `Approved – within policy`.
6. Verify all four artifacts:
 - SharePoint: claim's Status changed to Approved
 - Email: claimant received the approval email
 - Teams channel: a message was posted with the claim details
 - Claims Audit Log: a new row exists with Outcome = Approved

Step 7.3 — Test path 2: high-value, rejected

1. Submit another claim with amount $\geq 5,000$.
2. This time, click **Reject** in Teams. Comment: `Needs additional documents..`
3. Verify: Status = Rejected, claimant got the rejection email with comments, Teams post shows Reject, audit log row has Outcome = Rejected.

Step 7.4 — Test path 3: fast-track, approved

1. Submit a claim with `ClaimAmount = 1500` (or any value $< 5,000$).
2. The approval should land with the fast-track approver this time, with the 'Fast-track:' prefix.
3. Approve. Verify all four artifacts.

Step 7.5 — Test path 4: fast-track, rejected

1. Submit another low-value claim.
2. Reject. Verify all four artifacts.

Step 7.6 — Inspect a flow run when something looks wrong

1. From the flow's detail page, scroll to **28-day run history**.
2. Click any run to inspect each step's input and output.
3. Red exclamation marks indicate failed steps; click them to see the error.
4. The **Resubmit** button (top of a failed run) re-runs the same trigger event after you've fixed the flow.

Verify Part 7

BEFORE MOVING ON

- ✓ All four paths tested successfully.
- ✓ Approver received the correct title prefix in Teams (High-value vs Fast-track).
- ✓ Status, email, channel post, and audit log update consistently across all four paths.
- ✓ Email body for rejections includes the reviewer's comments.
- ✓ Audit log Outcome reads 'Approved' or 'Rejected' (not 'Approve' or 'Reject').

Part 8 — Troubleshooting reference

Cross-reference symptoms against likely causes before raising your hand.

Symptom	Most likely cause and how to fix it
The flow doesn't trigger when I add a SharePoint item.	SharePoint triggers can take 3–5 minutes on first fire and slow further if your tenant is busy. Wait 5 min. If still nothing, check the flow is 'On'. Last resort: use the Test → Manually option from the flow page to bypass the trigger latency.
The flow runs but the approval card never appears in Teams.	The Assigned to field contains a group, distribution list, or shared mailbox — not a named licensed user. Open the approval action and change Assigned to a real person's email. Existing in-flight runs will not retroactively fix; you'll need to submit a new test claim.
I get a 'cannot use this output' validation error.	You're trying to reference dynamic content from a step that hasn't run yet (or runs on a different branch). Power Automate scopes outputs strictly: an action in 'If no' can't see outputs from 'If yes', even if both come from the same approval type. Pick the correct branch's outputs.
Update item overwrites my data with blanks.	Update item requires every column the list considers 'required' to be supplied. If you leave a required field blank, Power Automate writes an empty value. Pass the original value back via dynamic content for every required field — change only the columns you actually want to update.
Outcome comparison always falls into one branch.	You wrote 'Approved' or 'Rejected' instead of 'Approve' or 'Reject'. The Outcome returns the verb (Approve / Reject), not the past tense. Edit the inner condition to compare to 'Approve' exactly.
Email arrives but Choice fields show as numbers or 'Record'.	You picked ClaimType (the record) or ClaimType Id (the internal number). Repick ClaimType Value from the dynamic content panel.
The audit-log entry has the wrong outcome string.	Your if() expression references the wrong step name. Power Automate expressions use underscored step names — 'Senior approval' becomes 'Senior_approval'. If you renamed steps, your old expression breaks.
The flow used to work, now every run fails.	Likely a connection auth issue. Open the flow's Connections panel and confirm the SharePoint, Teams, Office 365 Outlook, and Approvals connectors all show 'Connected' (no warning icon). Refresh any that show errors.

Symptom	Most likely cause and how to fix it
Senior approver is on leave, approvals are piling up.	Open the approval in Teams → click '...' → Reassign. For permanent reassignment, edit the flow and update the Assigned to field; new claims will route correctly.
The flow runs twice for some claims.	You probably enabled 'Trigger conditions' incorrectly, or the SharePoint event fired twice (rare, but happens). Add a check at the top of the flow: if Status is already not 'Submitted', terminate immediately.
The audit log shows blank Approver.	You bound Approver Claims to the wrong field. Use [Responder email] or [Responder] from the approval's dynamic content — not the Assigned to field (which is who was asked, not who responded).
Email goes to the flow owner, not the claimant.	Your Claims Intake list doesn't capture a claimant email. Either add a ClaimantEmail column to the list and surface it on the Lab 1 app's form, or pre-populate via the User().Email pattern in Power Apps.

Part 9 — Stretch goals

After the workshop, pick one stretch goal and ship it within thirty days. Each is independently valuable.

Sentiment-based escalation

Add AI Builder's sentiment analysis to inspect the claim's Description at trigger time. If sentiment is below a threshold (say 0.3, indicating frustration or distress), escalate the routing — send even low-value claims to a senior reviewer who handles sensitive cases.

1. After the trigger, add an action: **Analyse positive or negative sentiment** (AI Builder).
2. Pass [Description] to the Text parameter.
3. Change the routing Condition to AND-combine two clauses:

```
ClaimAmount >= 5000    OR    sentimentScore < 0.3
```

4. Senior reviewer now handles both high-value claims AND low-sentiment cases regardless of amount.

SLA escalation

If the approver doesn't respond within 48 hours, escalate to their manager. Power Automate's approval action has a timeout option — but it's better to use a parallel 'Delay until' branch that triggers a reminder Teams post, then a manager escalation.

1. After the approval, add a **Delay** of 48 hours.
2. Then a Condition: if **Outcome** is still null (pending), post a reminder to Teams and start a NEW approval to the manager.
3. In practice this is more elegant with the **Parallel branch** feature — research it after the workshop.

Sequential multi-approver for high-value claims

Replace the senior approval action with the 'Start and wait for an approval' type 'Approve/Reject — Everyone must approve' if you need consensus, OR chain two separate approvals (head of claims, then head of risk) for staged sign-off.

Sequential is heavier — only use it for genuinely high-stakes claims (above, say, RM 50,000).

SMS notifications via a premium connector

Office 365 Outlook is free. SMS connectors (Twilio, Vonage, MessageBird) are premium. For high-value claim updates, an SMS is more reliable than email. Add it as a parallel branch after the inner condition — email AND SMS, not email OR SMS.

Retakaful escalation trigger

For very large claims that require retakaful (reinsurance), the flow shouldn't just send an email — it should generate a structured package and post to the retakaful submission system. Add a third branch

(claims $\geq$ RM 100,000) that calls an Adapter action or a custom connector to your retakaful partner's API.

Auto-routing for renewal-period spikes

During end-of-year renewal periods, claim volume spikes. Add a switch action that checks the current month and routes to a 'surge team' approver group instead of the regular ones.

Part 10 — Self-check

Final checklist. Tick each item; if any is missing, scroll back to the relevant part.

Data layer

- ☐ 'Claims Audit Log' SharePoint list exists with all seven columns.
- ☐ Outcome column has three choices: Approved, Rejected, Auto-Routed.
- ☐ ClaimID is a Number column.

Flow structure

- ☐ Flow named 'Claims Approval & Routing' is saved and turned on.
- ☐ Trigger renamed to 'When a new claim is created' and points to Takaful Claims Intake list.
- ☐ Routing condition is ClaimAmount $\geq$ 5000.
- ☐ Both branches have a Teams approval action (Senior approval + Fast-track approval).
- ☐ Each approval has a different licensed user as Assigned to.
- ☐ Approval titles use dynamic content with a distinguishing prefix.

Response handling

- ☐ Both branches have an inner Condition: Outcome equals 'Approve' (verb, not past tense).
- ☐ Inner branches Update item with Status = 'Approved' or 'Rejected'.
- ☐ Inner branches send Office 365 Outlook emails with different bodies for approved vs rejected.
- ☐ Update item passes original values for required fields (no blank-overwrites).

Notification + audit

- ☐ Both branches post to the same Teams channel with claim details.
- ☐ Both branches write to Claims Audit Log.
- ☐ Audit log Outcome uses the if() expression translating 'Approve' → 'Approved'.
- ☐ Audit log captures Approver, ClaimID, ClaimantName, Comments and DecisionTimestamp = utcNow().

End-to-end testing

- ☐ Path 1 tested: high-value, approved.

- ☐ Path 2 tested: high-value, rejected.
- ☐ Path 3 tested: fast-track, approved.
- ☐ Path 4 tested: fast-track, rejected.
- ☐ Every test produced: status update, claimant email, Teams post, audit log row.

Production-ready

- ☐ Flow has been saved AND is turned on.
- ☐ No red error indicators on any step.
- ☐ Approvers know to expect approval cards in their Teams notifications.
- ☐ Audit log has at least four rows from the four test runs.

IF EVERY BOX IS TICKED

You've built an end-to-end claims approval workflow with audit trail, Teams integration, and dual-tier routing — in 90 minutes. Combined with Lab 1, you now own a closed-loop claims system that would have taken a traditional IT project six months to deliver.

Take a Loom recording of submitting a claim, the approval landing in Teams, the email arriving, and the audit log entry appearing. This is the single most persuasive artefact you can carry into your next compliance or board conversation.